

Mike Sims

+1 850-445-6295 | Mike@Simspatial.com | <https://www.linkedin.com/in/fmikesims/> | Atlanta, GA, USA

Overview

Product manager, engineering team leader, and **geospatial** technology consultant with over 17 years of experience in **geospatial software** product **management**, focusing on **geospatial**, machine learning, data, and platform-oriented solutions. Adept at driving product strategy, leading cross-functional teams, and delivering innovative products across **transportation**/logistics, public health, EO, and insurance verticals that enable business stakeholders to leverage and understand their data effectively. A product leader with an established record of inspiring teams to execute a vision and drive innovation.

Professional Experience

SimSpatial GIS Consulting LLC | 10/2014 - Current | Atlanta, GA

Founder/Product Leader/Software Developer:

- Directed strategy and product development for custom cloud-based SaaS **mapping**/GIS solutions. Provided full stack development, architecture **services**, and **web application** prototyping using **SQL**, **Python**, **JavaScript**, **TypeScript**, **HTML**, & **CSS**.
- Work remotely across the globe with global non-profits and public health agencies, including: *The Bill and Melinda Gates Foundation*, *The Task Force for Global Health*, *RTI International*, and *The International Trachoma Initiative*, *The Carter Center*, & *The London School of Hygiene and Tropical Medicine*.
- Developed *NTDMap*, a cloud-based SaaS **web mapping** product, and provided advanced **spatial data analysis** with **Python**, and **SQL database** design.
- Expert Legal Witness providing legal testimony related to GIS methodology, LiDAR modeling, GIS data collection, property boundaries, and data processing through multiple levels of litigation including deposition and trial. Developed a Cloud-based SaaS **Web Map** of Property Boundaries and LiDAR Elevation models for use during the deposition and trial. *Walton Co Florida Customary Use Trial # 2018-CA-000547*

Norfolk Southern Corp | 05/2016 – 05/2024 | Atlanta, GA

Senior Product Manager | 12/2019 – 05/2024

- Led product strategy, design, and delivery of 34 SaaS data products, including business intelligence, data visualization, and **mobile mapping** apps within the Engineering Technology Group of a Fortune 300 company.
- Owned product roadmap, prioritizing products and features for maximum performance and user benefit, integrating machine learning, **geospatial**, and complex data analytics pipelines.
- Worked with data teams (Big Data engineers, data scientists, **software** developers, GIS data analysts) to integrate machine learning and predictive data analytics pipelines while aligning with corporate long-term strategy.
- Maximized ROI by leveraging the existing terabytes of enterprise digital twin data in Oracle **Spatial SQL**, AWS, geodatabases, and **ESRI ArcGIS** Server technology stack to develop 35+ new **spatial** data APIs used across 60+ internal enterprise apps.
- Practiced Agile **software** development using JIRA and GitHub, leading to a 200% increase in release velocity.
- Leveraged leadership and expert communication skills leading our remote teams to deliver 8 new product launches and over 30 major feature enhancements during the pandemic.
- Interviewed and collaborated with 100's of end-users to identify and fill product gaps and develop new product ideas, creating insights and experiences that enrich business processes and workflow improvements based on user feedback and data analytics.
- Redesigned **UI/UX** and led the Engineering Dev Team to deliver our flagship SaaS **Web Mapping** Product, *MSGIS*, enhancing performance up to 200X and enhancing user experiences across the board. This is a hybrid-cloud, SaaS **web mapping** platform (React/TypeScript/**ArcGIS JS API**/Oracle **Spatial** DB + AWS) integrated with Google Maps, Bing Maps, NOAA Weather Data APIs, **ESRI** Satellite Imagery **Services**, and 120+ **ArcGIS** Server **API**'s, Big Data pipelines, AI/ML derived data & video feeds. Used daily by 3,000+ internal users to aid mission-critical decision making.
- Coordinated with cross-functional teams in a complex, matrixed organization to design and build *Storm Mapper*, a hybrid-cloud, SaaS **web** and **mobile mapping** platform (**ESRI JavaScript API**/**ESRI** Field Maps) allowing real-time emergency response, leading to reduced response times and increased coordination of 300+ field users.

Project Manager | 05/2017 – 12/2019

- Managed creation of the enterprise GIS digital twin for a \$4B mission-critical, federally mandated, industry-wide safety initiative, Positive Train Control (PTC). Streamlined data production and reported to executive leadership.
- Delivered this **project** 6 months ahead of schedule through effective cross-functional team **integration** and process optimization.
- Maintained exceptional working relationships with stakeholders across all levels of the organization and external industry partners to ensure compliance and process adoption across all stakeholders.

Software Developer | 05/2016 – 05/2017

- Developed custom GIS **software** products and managed **software** development life cycle using **ArcGIS** REST APIs, Oracle **Spatial SQL**, **Python**, .Net & C#, enhancing the rollout velocity of the PTC **project** using waterfall and Agile **software** development methodologies.

Florida Department of Health | 05/2013 – 10/2014 | Tallahassee, FL

GIS Manager:

- Managed GIS Department and staff and served as product development for emergency preparedness and provided **geospatial** analytics during national disasters.
- GIS Product Manager for custom **mapping software** & server infrastructure projects & vendor contracts.
- Managed GIS Department & staff in **support** of CDC Public Health Emergency Preparedness agreement for 350+ users in 67 county health departments.
- Provided **geospatial** data analytics & statistical **analysis**, **mapping**, solution architecture, and subject matter expertise to the Florida Surgeon General's Office.

Florida State University Dept. of Geography | 08/2009 – 05/2013 | Tallahassee, FL

Graduate Research Assistant:

- Researched and developed Machine Learning Image Classification algorithms for **spatial** data **analysis**, published academic articles, and presented findings at international and domestic conferences.

Citizens Property Insurance Corp. | 01/2007- 08/2009 | Tallahassee, FL

Consultant & GIS Analyst:

- Designed and deployed an enterprise-level GIS **system** and provided statistical analytics to executive leadership at the 2nd largest Property Insurance Company in Florida.

Certifications

- Supervised Machine Learning: Regression and Classification – Stanford University Online – 2024
- Product **Management** for AI/ML – Google ELVTR Online Course – 2024

Education

PhD (ABD) – Geography | *Florida State University* | *Tallahassee, FL*

Dissertation Title: **Integration** of LiDAR for use in Object-based Image Classification of Urban Structures and Land Cover from GeoEye-1 Satellite Imagery

MS - Geographic Information Science | *Florida State University* | *Tallahassee, FL* | 2006

BS - Environmental Studies/Geography | *Florida State University* | *Tallahassee, FL* | 2005

Technology Summary

- **Languages/Technologies:** **JavaScript**, TypeScript, **Python**, R, **SQL** (Oracle, Postgres, MySQL, **SQL** Server), .NET, C#, NumPy, SciPy, ArcPy, Apache Spark, Apache Sedona, PySpark, D3.js, Leaflet.js, MapBox, React.js
- **GIS/Data Tools:** **ArcGIS** Pro & **ArcGIS** Server, **ArcGIS** Online, QGIS, Google Maps/Earth APIs, Pandas, Geopandas, Jupyter Notebooks
- **Platforms/Productivity:** AWS, Google App Engine, Windows Server IIS, Linux, iOS, Mac OSX, JIRA, GitHub, MS **Project**, MS Teams, MS Office Suite, Google Workspace suite Slack, Zoom

Mike Sims

- Atlanta, GA, US

Contact Information

- l7y-p93-9kb@mail.dice.com
- 8504456295

Summary

A customer-driven **geospatial software** product manager with 15+ years of experience currently driving innovation at a Fortune 300 company. I have experience leading multi-cultural, remote-work, cross-functional teams to plan, build, launch, and manage **geospatial software** solutions across the TransportationLogistics, Public Health, and Insurance verticals. I blend technical and people skills with Agile and waterfall **project management** experience. I exercise a client-first orientation to evolve product strategy. I have the proven ability to prioritize and manage multiple complex projects of various scales within time and budget restrictions. This is reflected in my business unit successes, happy customers, and satisfied executives. With a Master's Degree in GIS and research background in Remote Sensing, ML Image Processing (Satellite and LiDAR), and collegiate level teaching experience in GIS, **Spatial** Statistics, & Remote Sensing, I'm the person you want in the room to bridge the gap between complex technologies, analytics, and business. I also serve as CEOOwner of a boutique **Geospatial** Technology Consulting Company (SimSpatial GIS Consulting) providing **Software** Development, GIS Architecture, and **Geospatial** Technology Consulting.

Work History

Total Work Experience: 12 years

- **Product Manager Norfolk Southern Corp**
May 01, 2016
- **Founder Simspatial GIS Consulting**
Jan 01, 2014

- **GIS Manager Florida Department Of Health**
Oct 01, 2013

Education

- **Pre-Doctorate** | Florida State University
- **Bachelors** | Florida State University
- **Masters** | Florida State University

Skills

- **arcgis** - 17 years
- **data analysis** - 17 years
- **geographic information system** - 17 years
- **geospatial analysis** - 17 years
- **gis** - 17 years
- **mapping** - 17 years
- **business requirements** - 15 years
- **consulting** - 15 years
- **cross functional team** - 15 years
- **database** - 15 years
- **database administration** - 15 years
- **database architecture** - 15 years
- **postgres** - 15 years
- **sql** - 15 years
- **javascript** - 12 years
- **python** - 12 years
- **requirements analysis** - 12 years
- **machine learning** - 11 years
- **saas** - 11 years
- **solution architecture** - 11 years
- **cloud** - 10 years
- **google earth** - 10 years
- **leadership** - 10 years
- **oracle** - 10 years
- **product management** - 10 years
- **product roadmaps** - 10 years

- amazon **web services** - 5 years
- r - 5 years
- agile **application** development
- agile methodologies
- agile **project management**
- applied machine learning
- **arcgis** server
- **arcmap**
- artificial intelligence
- business process improvement
- cartography
- cross functional team leadership
- customer satisfaction
- data collection
- data **science**
- databases
- deep learning
- digital strategy
- enterprise gis
- environmental **science**
- erdas imagine
- **esri**
- geography
- geomatics
- **geoprocessing**
- **geospatial** intelligence
- **geospatial** technologies
- gis **analysis**
- gis **applications**
- gis **software**
- global product **management**
- go to **market** strategy
- gps
- **information** technology
- jira
- lidar
- linear regression
- logistic regression
- mac os
- **management**
- **mobile applications**
- new product release
- open source **software**
- os x
- postgres

- postgresql
- product leadership
- product operations
- product requirements
- product vision
- **project management**
- public speaking
- qgis
- react.js
- remote sensing
- **scripting**
- scrum
- server **management**
- **software** development
- **spatial**
- **spatial analysis**
- **spatial** data
- **spatial** databases
- statistical modeling
- statistics
- strategic planning
- supervised classification
- team leadership
- university teaching
- urban studies
- **web** development
- windows server
- public health - 11 years
- research - 8 years

Work Preferences

- Desired Work Settings: Remote or Hybrid
- Likely to Switch: False
- Willing to Relocate: True
- Travel Preference: 50%
- Preferred Location:
 - Jacksonville, FL, US
 - Seattle, WA, US
 - Washington, DC, US
- Work Authorization:
 - US
- Work Documents:

- US Citizen
- Security Clearance: False
- Desired Hourly Rate: 120+ (USD)
- Desired Salary: 150,000+ (USD)
- Third Party: False
- Employment Type:
 - Full-time
 - Contract - Corp-to-Corp
 - Contract - Independent
 - Contract to Hire - Corp-to-Corp
 - Contract to Hire - Independent
 - Contract to Hire - W2

Profile Sources

- linkedin: <https://www.linkedin.com/in/fmikesims>
- blog: <https://www.simspatial.com/portfolio>
- twitter: <https://twitter.com/fmsims>
- Dice:
<https://www.dice.com/employer/talent/profile/823c3b7f6efa48a05776cb79c4357a19>